

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Nasals and Breteches

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

Nasal and Breteche bascinets are medieval helmets that originated in the early 14th century. They are an evolution of simple bascinets worn with chainmail. The chainmail aventail is attached to the front of the helmet to increase its face protection.

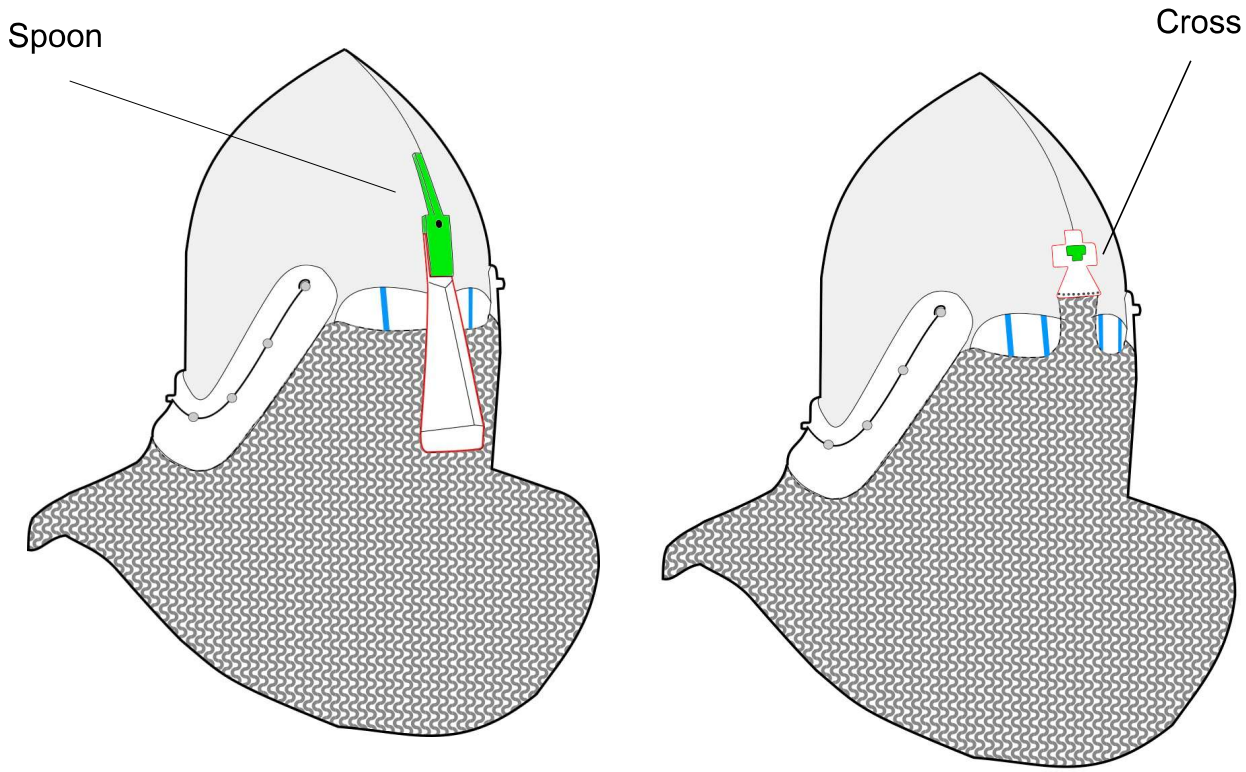
Nasal bascinet uses a solid metal nasal to protect the nose, attached on the forehead by a piece of metal, the “spoon”.

Breteche bascinet uses chainmail to protect the nose, attached on the forehead by a piece of metal, the “cross”.

Both helmets were used from 1340 to the late 14th century in Western Europe.

Nasal and breteche bascinets are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.

Nasal and breteche bascinets are **Denied** for **15th century armors**.



3. Historical Sources and Datation

3.1. Nasal Helmet



Second half of the 14th century (datation unknown) - France



Günther XXI. von Schwarzburg - 1349 - Germany

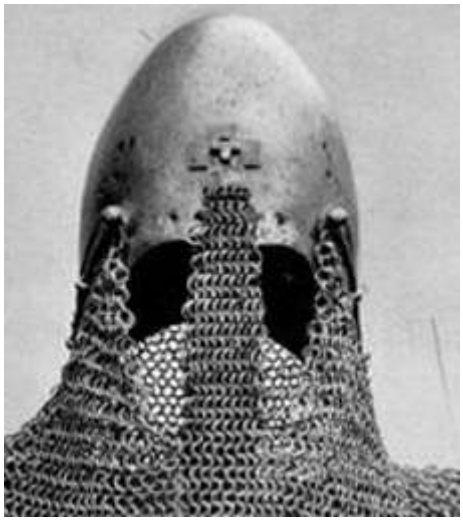


Galeotto Malaspina - 1367 - Italy



BKE Cod. 339 Der Passionstraktat des Nikolaus Schulmeister - 1396 - Switzerland

3.2. Breteche Helmet





Museo Stibbert, Florence - Second half of the 14th century (datation unknown) - Italy

Note: This artifact may not be 100% original, as the founder of the museum commissioned some fiorentina armorers in 1881 to adapt and repair the skull, to create the cross and the chainmail (maybe original pieces of mail were patched up).



Doge's Palace, Venice - 1350/1370 - Italy



Klosterneuburg Stiftsmuseum - 1335/1340 - Austria

4. Requirements

4.1. General Requirements

Reproductions must closely resemble the appearance and proportions of a Nasal or a Breteche helmet source.

Any metal part of the helmet must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"* document.

Any textile or leather part of the helmet must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather"* document.

4.2. Visor

Visors must be made of metal grill or plates, concealed under chainmail.

Chainmail must be properly attached to the visor with metal, leather or fabric thread.

Visors must not be too long or too short and respect the proportions of historical sources.

Nasal helmet visor bottom line must end between nose and chin.

The fixation system must be reproduced as per historical sources ("spoon" or "cross").

It is allowed to add a metal plate to protect the throat. Such a plate must be strong enough to endure full contact fight and must be concealed under the Aventail.

4.3. Eye slots

Eye slots should resemble sources for the visor.

Eye slots should not exceed 25mm tall to prevent any injury.

It is allowed to add up to two (2) safety Eye bars per Eye slot. Externally riveted Eye bars and integrated Eye bars are not allowed.

Eye bars must conform to the "*Eye bars"* rules document.

4.4. Aventail

Nasal and Breteche helmets must be worn with chainmail Aventails. Fabric or scales Aventails are not allowed.

Aventails must conform to the "*Aventails"* document.

Aventails must be attached to the bascinet by a suspension system made of vervelles and leather.

The Aventail must be fastened down to the edge of a padded pelerine attached to the helmet liner.

Any additional protective plates covering the cervical spine must be hidden under the Aventail.

4.5. Others

Nasal and Breteche helmets may be decorated in the spirit of medieval styles, such as orle, torse, decorated Aventails (with copper/brass chainmail rings), vervelle covers and coat of arms badges, etc. Such decoration must be made in coherence with historical sources.

Using modern and/or offensive imagery and slogans is prohibited.

5. Examples of Approved Reproductions

Example of approved welded spoon









Pictures from The Medieval Things ©





Pictures from The Medieval Things ©



Picture from M. Leclere ©

6. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Eyebars not painted in black





Chainmail not attached properly





Overall design does not reproduce historical sources, including improper chainmail fixation on the forehead (no cross) =>





<= Aventail mixing fabric and chainmail

Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Replace:
- In 4.1 General Requirements: “Klappvisor” by “Nasal or a Breteche helmet”

Add:
- In 4.3 Eye slots: ”Externally riveted and integrated eyebars are not allowed.”

February-2025 (2025.03)
Formatting: grammar and formatting

December-2024: -Add
Document has been created